Saleh Abdullah Alsubaie

Senior Mechanical Engineering Student | Unmanned Systems, Systems Engineering, Business Development

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Profile

Senior Mechanical Engineering student with a record of leading teams and delivering commercial outcomes. Founder of MIRQAB, a drone-based water intelligence system for industrial operations, and originator of NavPod, 2nd place winner at Defensathon 2026. At JNH Systems, built the business case for an autonomy initiative and led the company presence at LEAP 2026, lifting booth engagement 35% and securing 2 POC agreements. Graduating January 2027 and seeking a cooperative training placement in engineering, autonomous systems or business development.

Working Experience

UAV Systems Engineer / Business Development Engineer (Part-time), *JNH Systems* 04/2026 – Present

- Built the business strategy and technical validation plan for an autonomy initiative, covering competitive benchmarking, use case definition and presentations to senior stakeholders
- Led business development for the docking station line, turning CAPEX and OPEX per station into payback and margin curves that set pricing and go-to-market direction
- Led the company presence at LEAP 2026, lifting booth engagement 35% and securing 2 new POC agreements
- Owned the mechanical design of the docking station from requirements to working prototype, coordinating suppliers and design reviews

Business Development Intern, *TalMal* 10/2026 – Present

- Source and onboard merchants into the network of a Saudi salary-backed pay-later fintech
- Pitch the service to employers so their employees can benefit from it

UAV Engineering Intern, *QSS AI & Robotics* 06/2026 – 08/2026

- Presented the department and its platforms to visiting delegations and investors, translating capability for non-technical decision makers
- Owned the full bill of materials, balancing fixed cost and performance targets across the platform
- Designed a fixed-wing platform from a clean sheet, carrying it from concept through detailed design to build

MEP Site Engineer Intern, *Athlath Construction* 07/2025 – 09/2025

- Coordinated multidisciplinary site crews of 15+ tradesmen against daily targets on an active construction site
- Reviewed 11+ engineering drawings across HVAC, plumbing and firefighting scopes and resolved clashes with contractors
- Oversaw on-site installations and enforced HSE requirements, working to a zero-incident standard

Projects

Founder & Team Lead, NavPod, Defensathon 2nd Place & SAR 15,000 Prize Winner 01/2026 – Present

- Originated the concept and led a multidisciplinary team from first idea to 2nd place nationally, setting technical direction, allocating workstreams and owning delivery against a fixed deadline
- Positioned NavPod as a plug-in upgrade that lets existing drone fleets navigate without GPS
- Built the full flight simulation from scratch to validate the concept and support the pitch to judges
- Managed the hardware budget and procurement for the demo build, holding the pod to its 575 g weight target

Founder, MIRQAB, Water Intelligence System for Industrial Operations 2026 – Present

- Built the value model on a live mining case: $484K gross annual value per facility, 3.2x return, 3.7-month payback

Professional Leadership Development Graduate, Misk Community / Akwaf Association 11/2025 – 01/2026

- Co-led a 5-member team on the Masar project, securing 2nd place

Drone Operation & Drone Systems Development Bootcamps, Tuwaiq Academy 10/2025 – 01/2026

- Led an autonomous aerial survey with a DJI Matrice 300 RTK, turning 147 images over 4,342 sqm into a 3D terrain model and orthomosaic

Education

Bachelor's Degree in Mechanical Engineering, *Imam Mohammad Ibn Saud Islamic University* 2022 – 01/2027

Skills

Leadership & Coordination
Cross-Functional Team Leadership, Project Lifecycle Management, Stakeholder Management, Executive Presentations, Vendor Management

Business & Commercial
Business Case Development, Financial Modeling, CAPEX/OPEX Analysis, Feasibility Study, Go-to-Market Strategy, Proposal Writing, Risk Assessment

Operations & Data
Asset Inspection, Survey and Mapping, Geospatial Data (GIS), Remote Sensing, Telemetry & Ground Control Systems, HSE Compliance

Engineering & Tools
UAV Design & Operations, ArduPilot, Mission Planner, Autonomous Navigation, SLAM, Photogrammetry, SolidWorks, CAD, MATLAB, Simulink, C++, 3D Printing, PCB Design, HVAC Design

Certificates & Languages

GACA Part 107 Non-Recreational UAV License *(165+ flight hours)*

Drone Operation & Development Bootcamps, *Tuwaiq Academy (165 hrs)*

Forward Program, *McKinsey & Company* 09/2026

Certified Associate in Project Management (CAPM), *Project Management Institute* In Progress

TOEFL iBT, *ETS* In Progress

OSHA Safety Certification, *Occupational Safety and Health Administration* In Progress

Languages: Arabic, English